WHAT WE BUILT

Sam on Ashby

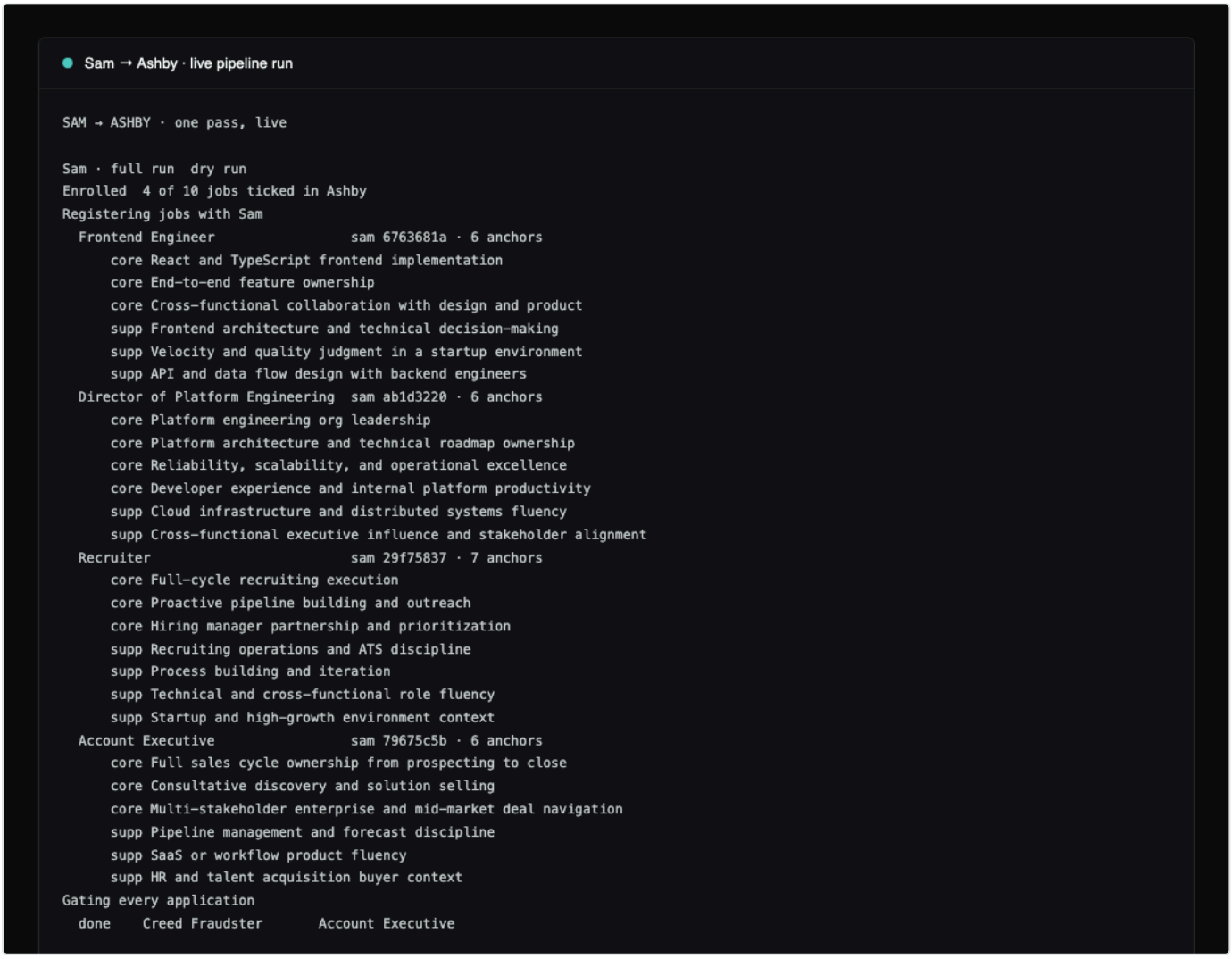
A recruiter opens a candidate in Ashby and Sam's read is already on the page — a score, the reasoning behind it, and the full write-up attached. Nobody has to go and fetch it.

How it runs

Every few hours, on its own:

- We look at which jobs the employer has switched Sam on for
- We send Sam the job description, and Sam works out what the role actually requires
- We go through everyone who has applied and work out who is new
- We send Sam each new person's CV, and Sam scores them against that job
- We put the result on their Ashby record — four places, covered overleaf

Nobody runs anything. Nobody copies anything between systems.

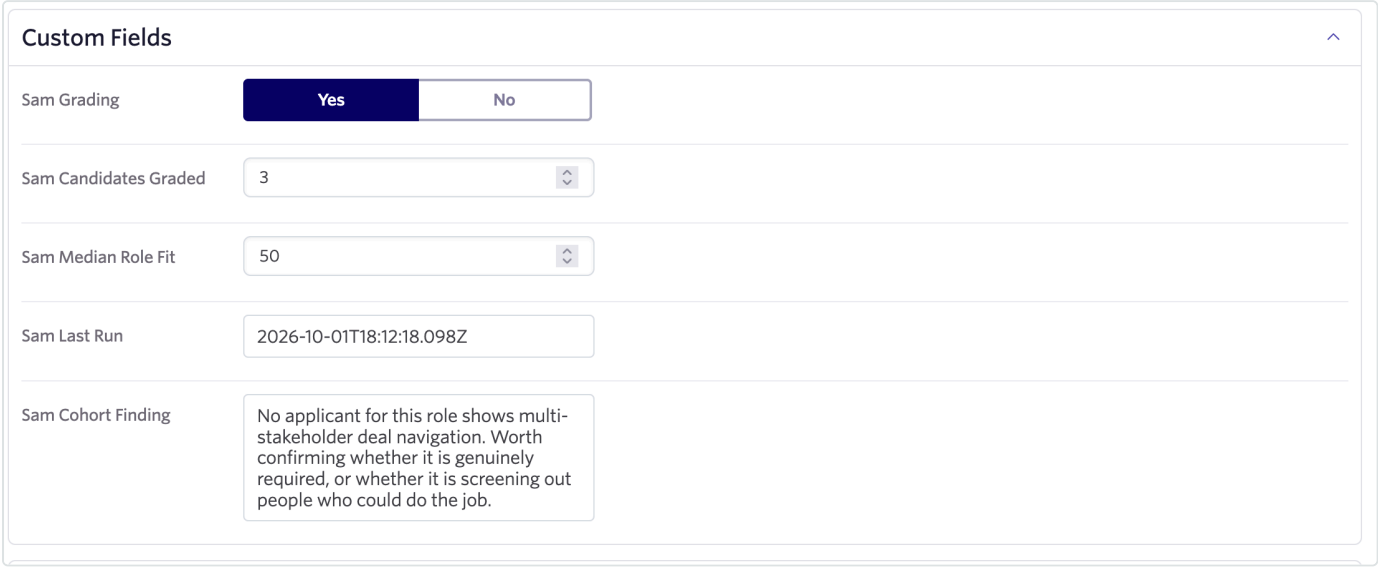


Our tool, not Ashby. One run: four jobs switched on, and the requirements Sam worked out for each from its job description.

Turning it on is one checkbox

The employer gives us an Ashby key. That is the whole setup — we create everything else ourselves. To switch Sam on for a role, someone ticks a box on that job in Ashby:

- Only jobs with the box ticked get graded
- Unticking it stops Sam on that role
- There is no separate login, no list of job IDs to send us, nothing to configure



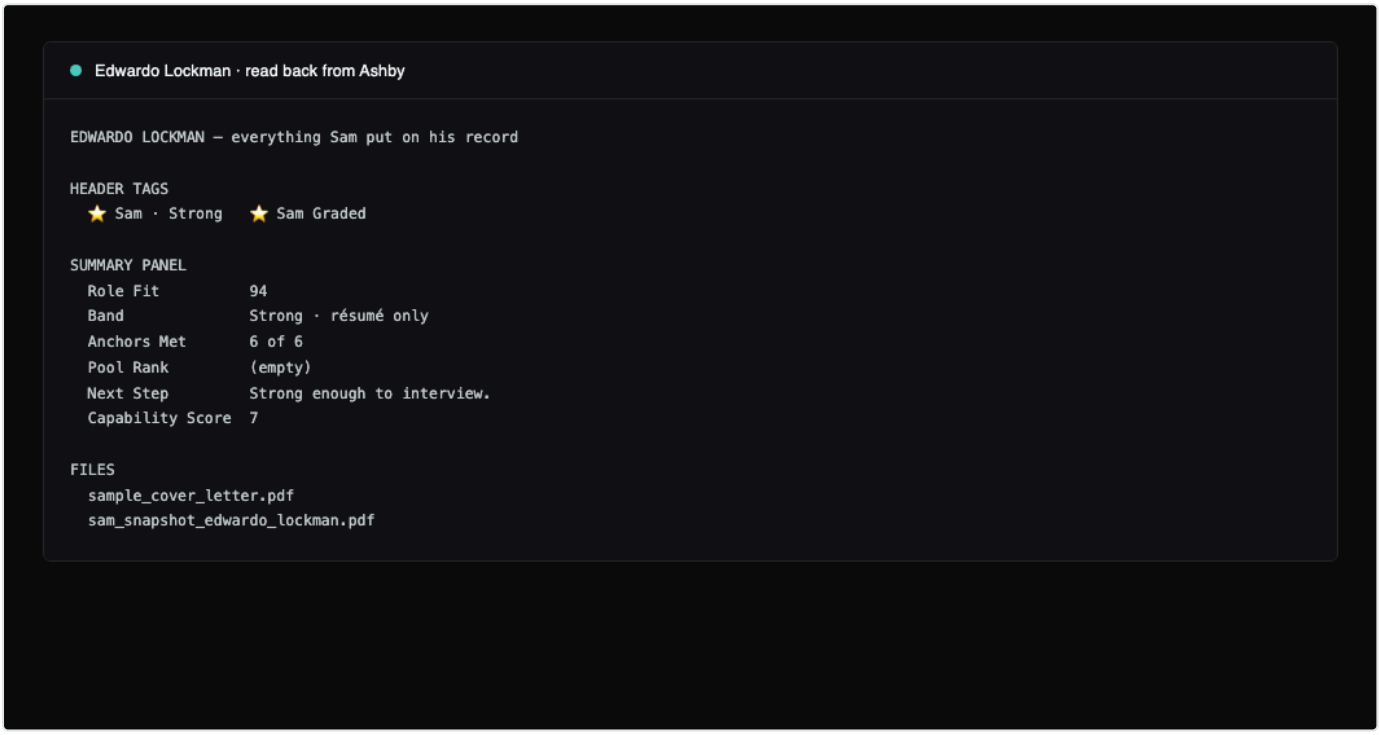
Ashby, the real job page. "Sam Grading" is the employer's own on/off switch; the rest fills in as Sam runs.

The last line is worth reading. Sam looks across **everyone** who applied and tells the employer something about their own job advert: *"No applicant for this role shows multi-stakeholder deal navigation. Worth confirming whether it is genuinely required, or whether it is screening out people who could do the job."*

What a recruiter sees first

On the candidate's page, in the panel beside their CV:

- **A score out of 100** — the thing they can sort and filter by
- **A verdict** — Strong, Partial, Not a match — and what it was based on
- **How many of the job's requirements were met**, out of how many there are
- **Where they rank** against the other people who applied to that job
- **What to do next**, in one line



The values on Edwardo Lockman's record, read back from Ashby.

The summary on their record

Sam also leaves a short note in the candidate's activity feed — the first thing a recruiter sees when they open someone. It is deliberately brief:

- The score, the verdict, and one sentence on what Sam made of them
- What to do next
- Each requirement on its own line, ticked or not
- Two or three things worth asking about in a screen
- A link to the full write-up attached below

It used to be three times this long. Ashby hides anything past a few lines behind a "Show more" that most people never click, so the detail moved to the attached document instead.



The note as it now reads. One strong, one partial — different at a glance.

The full write-up, attached

- Attached to the candidate in Ashby, so it travels with them
- Every requirement, with the evidence Sam found and how long ago
- Their own CV is bound in behind it, so it is one document rather than two
- Their original CV on the record is never touched or replaced
- A link back to the grading on Sam, on every page, since this gets emailed around

Edwardo Lockman

Matched to Director of Platform Engineering

Scored from résumé

94%
ROLE FIT
6 OF 6 ANCHORS
Strong

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Strong enough to interview. Confirm the $6M+ infrastructure budget at Carlson Civil was owned and accountable, not supported, and that the current Manager title at Ontraport reflects the same Director-level scope he held previously.

EXPERIENCE MATCH — Strong

Edwardo has held platform engineering leadership roles continuously since 2019, with direct ownership of reliability, developer experience, cloud infrastructure, and team scaling at four companies.

RESPONSIBILITY MATCH — Solid

Owned a $6M+ infrastructure budget and led teams of 28-31 engineers across 7 teams, but budget ownership appears only at Carlson Civil (2019-2021) and headcount has not grown beyond 31 across subsequent roles.

ROLE LEVEL FIT — Meets

Edwardo has held the Director title before and is currently operating as a manager with Director-equivalent scope, making this a lateral move with strong fit.

CAREER HISTORY

From résumé, as read by Sam

Platform Engineering Manager — Sep 2025 - Present
Ontraport

Senior Manager Platform Engineering — Aug 2023 - Apr 2025
Brand24

Senior Manager Platform Engineering — Dec 2021 - May 2023
Dashlane

Director of Platform Engineering — May 2019 - Sep 2021
Carlson Civil

CAPABILITY 7/10 **ANCHORS 6 MET OF 6**

How they work: Repeatable platform builder · Developer-centric operator · Org scaler under ambiguity.

ROLE ANCHORS

Platform engineering leadership and org scaling — MET

Led platform engineering orgs of 28-31 engineers across 7 teams at Dashlane and Brand24, and built a developer platform serving 423+ engineers at Ontraport. Held the Director of Platform Engineering title at Carlson Civil with a team of 31 engineers. (6+ years across four companies - current)

Platform technical strategy and architectural direction — MET

Drove cloud migration initiatives at three separate companies (Carlson Civil, Dashlane, Brand24) generating $3M-$5M in annual infrastructure savings each, indicating architectural decision ownership. Built the developer platform automation at Ontraport that cut deployment time from hours to 7 minutes. (6+ years - current)

Reliability, scalability, and operational excellence — MET

Improved system reliability from 95% to 99.9%+ uptime at Dashlane and from 98% to 99.9%+ at Ontraport. Two separate reliability uplift achievements across different orgs demonstrates repeatable operational discipline. (4+ years across two companies - current)

Developer experience and internal platform productivity — MET

Reduced developer deployment time from hours to 7 minutes through platform automation at Ontraport, serving 423+ engineers. Established a platform adoption program at Brand24 achieving 92% internal adoption rate. (3+ years across two companies - current)

The actual PDF attached to his Ashby record. Edwardo Lockman, Director of Platform Engineering — 94%, all six requirements met.

Finding the good ones

Ashby will not let you filter or sort a list by these scores — we checked, and a filter is accepted, ignored, and still reports success. So Sam also puts the verdict on a tag:

- ⭐ **Sam · Strong**, ⭐ **Sam · Partial**, ⭐ **Sam · Not a match**
- A tag is a chip on the record and a filter in candidate search straight away — **nothing to set up**
- Only ever one band per person: a re-score swaps it rather than leaving both

Sam also ranks people against the others who applied, but only at the moment it scores them — so the first person graded has no ranking, and everyone else's goes out of date as more apply. We keep our own record and work the order out fresh each run, and we do not show a ranking until at least four people can fairly be compared.

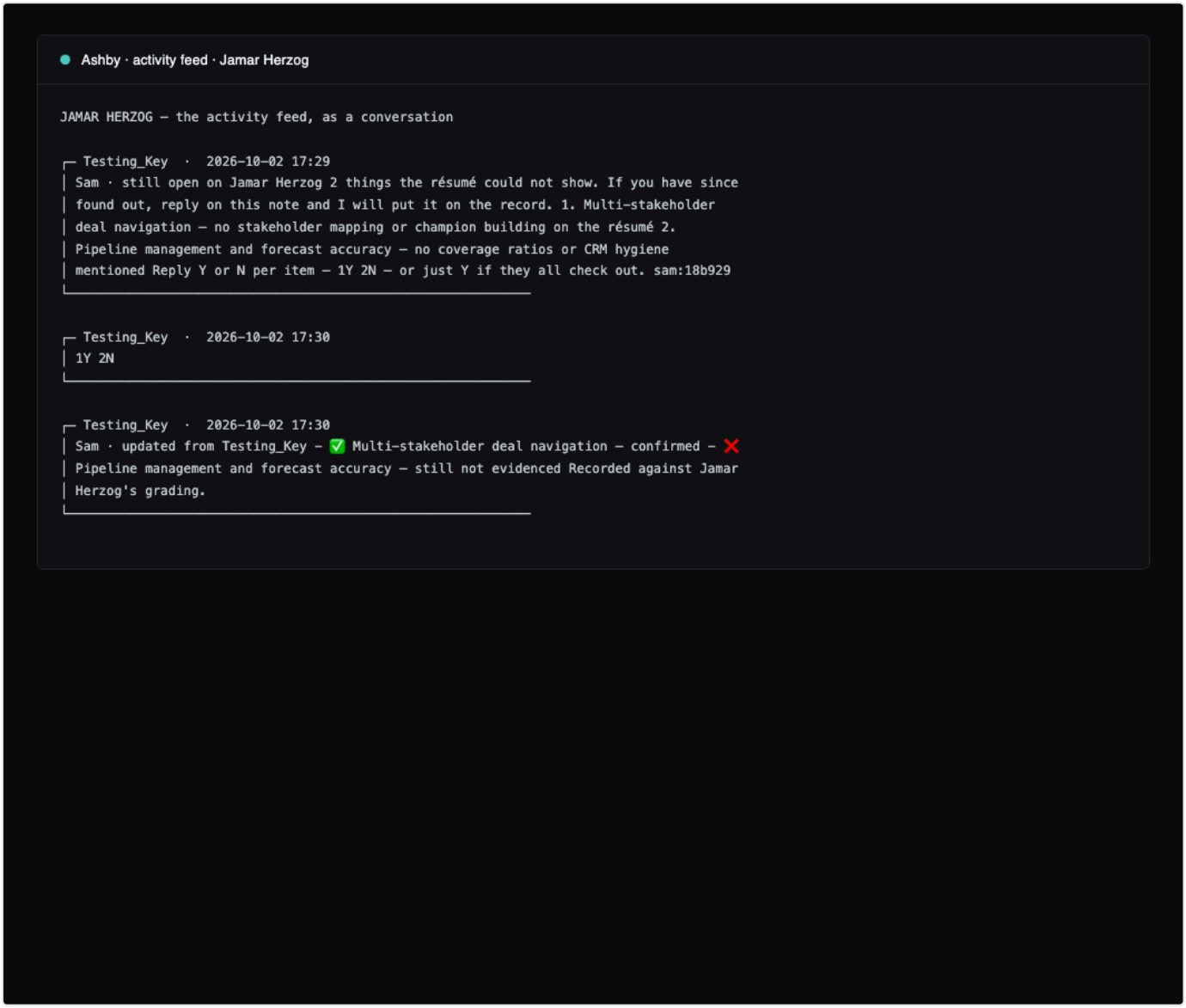


Everyone Sam has graded, with their tag. Read back from Ashby.

Sam can ask, and a recruiter can answer

Some things a CV simply cannot show. Sam used to list those once and that was the end of it — meanwhile the recruiter finds out in the screen, and that answer never makes it back onto the record.

- Sam posts its open questions as a numbered list on the candidate
- The recruiter replies in Ashby as they normally would — **1Y 2N**, or just **Y**
- The next run reads the reply and records it, with the name of who answered
- If a reply is unclear, the question stays open rather than being guessed at



Sam asks two questions, a reviewer answers, Sam records the result.

What we tested

- **Eight real candidates** scored by Sam across seven different jobs, from 15% to 94%
- Everything runs against the live Ashby account and the live Sam API — nothing is simulated
- Running it twice does not post anything twice, even if the system restarts midway
- Two runs starting at the same time cannot collide
- If Sam cannot read someone's CV, we retry a few times and then flag it for a person rather than giving up quietly
- If a job advert is edited after people were graded, we notice and say so
- **198 automated tests** and **22 live checks**, all passing

Still to do

- **Put it on a timer.** It currently runs when we run it. Scheduling it, and alerting someone if it fails, is the last piece.
- **Receive results automatically.** Sam can push results to us when scoring finishes, which needs an address we host. For now we ask Sam for them one candidate at a time, which works and is slower.
- **One number we do not get.** Sam tells us how well someone matched, but not how much of the role it was able to judge from a CV alone. We use Sam's own judgement of whether a score should stand instead.

Sam ↔ Ashby · 2 October 2026